
What customer details should stay out of an unapproved AI tool?
Customer message
Hi, I'm having an issue with my recent invoice. Can you take a look?
Name:
Phone:
Account ID:
Invoice ID:
Safe summary for AI
Customer is having an issue with a recent invoice and needs a reply. Draft a helpful, professional response without including any personal or account details.
Human review
No identifying details
Clear and accurate
Appropriate for sharing
Approval required
AI tool

What problem are we solving?

3 hours: 50-minute lesson, 10-minute break, 50-minute guided practice, 10-minute break, 50-minute applied practice, and 10-minute wrap-up.

SITUATION

The problem

An employee wants AI to draft a customer response, but the source message contains identifying and account information that should not be pasted into an unapproved tool.

TARGET

Learning goal

Identify sensitive information, minimize or replace it when permitted, and check workplace rules before using AI.

Practice material: Use the practice material supplied in the session Markdown.

Use these supplied facts

Do not replace missing information with guesses.

CASE MATERIAL

Practice message (fictional)

- "Mina Park, account 84721, called 555-0184 about invoice 3029. She says the package arrived damaged and asks what to do." Treat names, phone numbers, and account or invoice identifiers as sensitive for this exercise.

BOUNDARY

Use the supplied facts

An employee wants AI to draft a customer response, but the source message contains identifying and account information that should not be pasted into an unapproved tool.

Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

Recognize identifiers and minimize the input

- In the fictional practice message, a person's name, phone number, account ID, and invoice ID are identifying details. The task only needs to know that a customer reports a damaged package and asks what to do. Removing unnecessary details reduces exposure. Removing a name alone does not guarantee anonymity if other details can still identify the person.

LEARN

Check authorization before using a tool

- A safe workflow begins with the organization's approved-tool and data-handling rules. If policy is unknown or the tool is not approved for customer data, do not upload the message; ask the responsible person. A classroom prompt is not permission to paste real customer records into a public AI service.

Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

Review the minimized output

- When policy permits the task, use only the minimum necessary facts. Check that the draft does not repeat private details, invent a refund promise, or state a policy that was not supplied. A person remains responsible for verifying accuracy, policy fit, tone, and privacy before a reply is sent.

APPLY

Three-step method

- Identify what is sensitive; check whether the tool and task are approved; minimize data and review the output before use.

What makes a prompt weak?

These examples come from the current session scenario.

AVOID

Weak example 1

```
Here is Mina's phone and account number. Write a
reply.
```

AVOID

Weak example 2

```
I removed her name, so this is definitely
anonymous.
Decide whether she deserves compensation.
```

A clearer, safer prompt

Keep the source, task, constraints, and output check visible.

USE

Improved example 1

```
Before using AI, list the data fields in this
sample that should be removed
or replaced. Do not draft a reply or repeat the
identifiers.
```

USE

Improved example 2

```
Assume company policy permits an approved AI tool
for this task.
Draft a neutral reply using only these facts: the
item arrived damaged;
the customer asks for next steps. Ask the
customer to use the secure support
channel to provide order details. Do not promise
a refund or repeat identifiers.
```

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

- Mark each sensitive field in the practice message. Create a minimized version that says only "customer reports a damaged package and requests next steps." Note that this classroom exercise does not authorize uploading real customer data.

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

APPLIED PRACTICE

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

- Using only the minimized description and the assumption that the tool is approved, draft a short reply that directs the customer to the secure support channel. Review it for invented policy promises and private details.

Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W12_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

One report for this session

- Introduction: Explain why the practice customer message should not be pasted into an unapproved AI tool.
- Method: Copy the safe prompt you used with the minimized description.
- Results: Include the marked-up practice message, the minimized version, and the draft reply.
- Conclusion: Include your human-review checklist and one check that must happen before anyone uses AI with real customer data.

How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

Success check

- No unnecessary identifier is included, tool approval is treated as a required check, and the draft makes no unsupported promise.